🩺 Medibot — Medical Information Chatbot (RAG)

Medibot is a **Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG)** chatbot that answers medical questions using a medical reference book as its knowledge base. It's built with **LangChain**, **Pinecone**, **Hugging Face embeddings**, **OpenAI GPT-4.1-mini** and **Flask**. It ships as a **Docker** image and deploys to **AWS EC2** through a **GitHub Actions** CI/CD pipeline.

> ⚠️ **Disclaimer:** Medibot only provides general medical information for educational purposes. It does not diagnose conditions or prescribe medication, and it is not a substitute for professional medical advice. In an emergency, contact your local emergency services.

📑 Table of Contents

- Features
- Architecture
- Tech Stack
- Project Structure
- Getting Started
- Building the Vector Index
- Running the App
- API Reference
- Docker
- CI/CD Deployment to AWS
- Configuration
- License

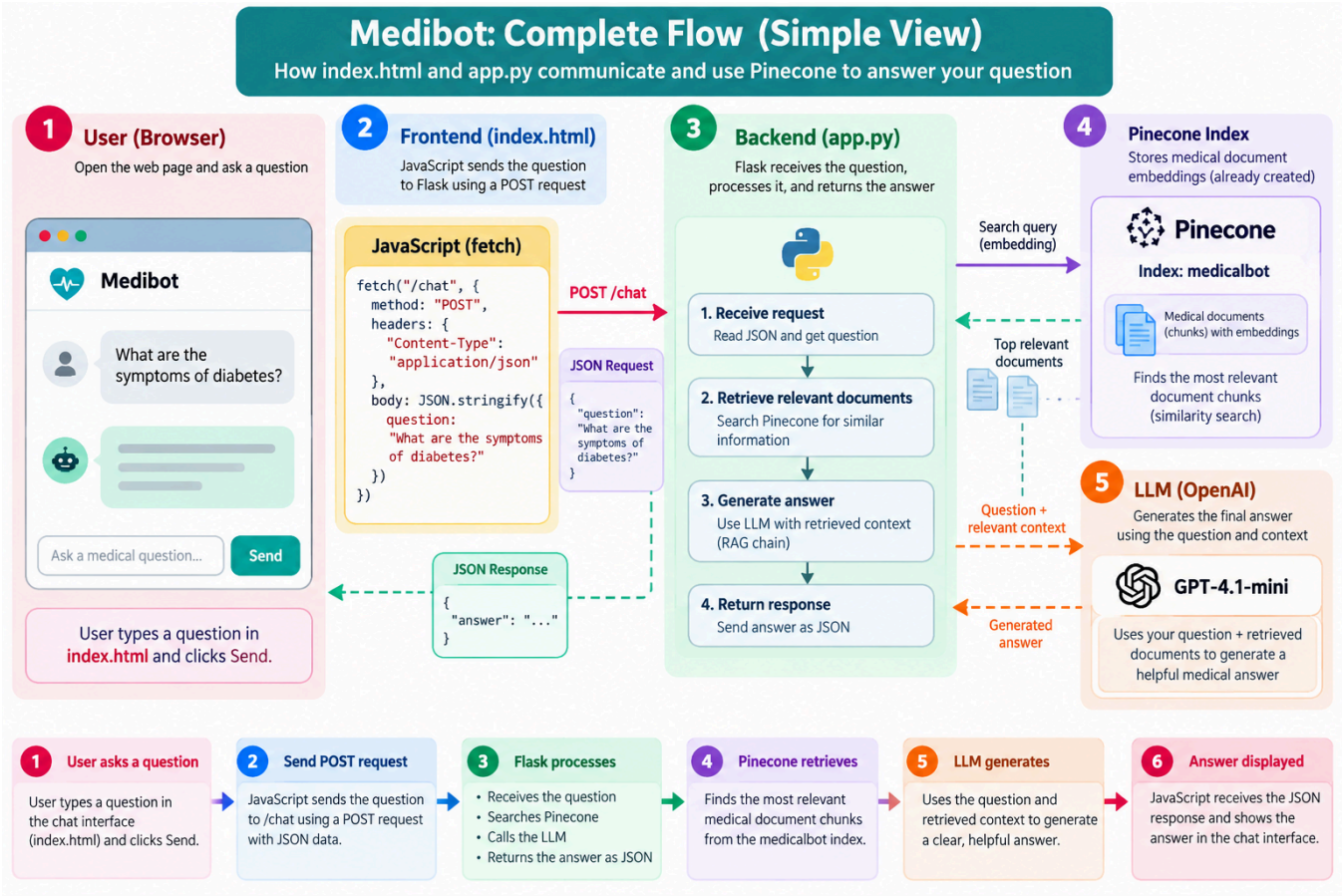
✨ Features

- **Answers grounded in documents:** relevant passages are retrieved from the medical book before the LLM answers.
- **Hybrid knowledge with guardrails:** the system prompt tells the model to:
- use the retrieved context first and say clearly when it adds general knowledge,
- point out disagreements between sources instead of merging them silently,
- never invent citations,
- never diagnose or prescribe,
- put urgent medical help first when a question sounds like an emergency.
- **Local embeddings:** text is embedded on the CPU with `BAAI/bge-base-en-v1.5` (768 dimensions). Embedding needs no API cost.

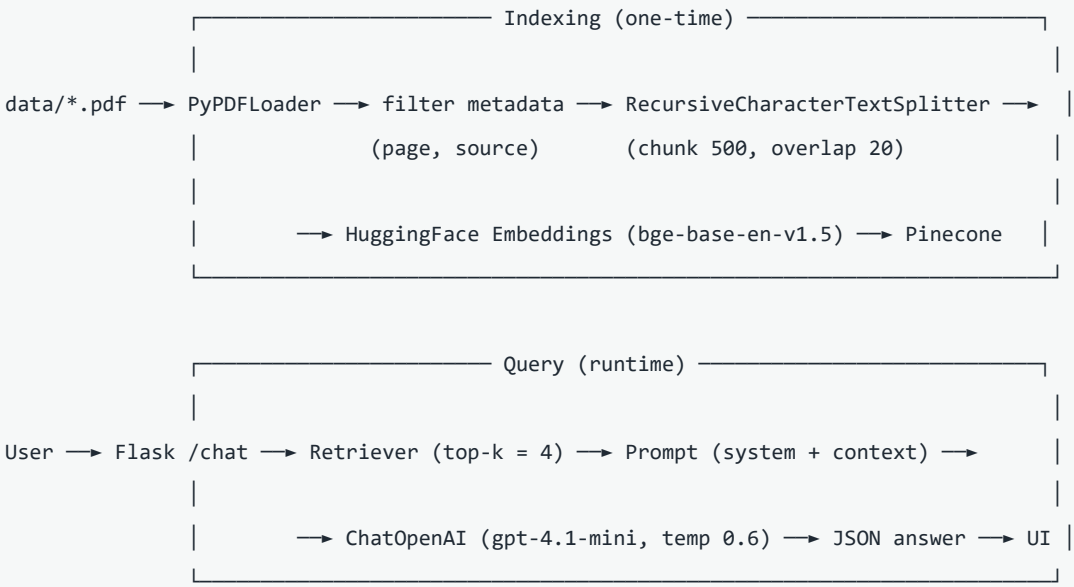
- **Serverless vector search:** a Pinecone index (cosine similarity, AWS `us-east-1`) stores the vectors.
- **Chat UI:** a clean, responsive single-page interface with suggested starter questions.
- **Automated deployment:** every push to `main` builds the Docker image, pushes it to Amazon ECR and runs it on an EC2 instance.

Architecture

Request flow



Indexing and query pipeline



1. **Ingestion** (src/store_index.py): loads every PDF in `data/`, keeps only the `page` and `source` metadata, splits the text into chunks, embeds the chunks and upserts them into Pinecone.
2. **Retrieval + generation** (app.py): connects to the existing Pinecone index, finds the 4 most similar chunks for each question, "stuffs" them into the prompt and asks the LLM for an answer.

🧰 Tech Stack

Layer	Technology
Language	Python 3.12
Web framework	Flask 3
LLM framework	LangChain (`langchain`, `langchain-classic`, `langchain-core`)
LLM	OpenAI `gpt-4.1-mini`
Embeddings	Hugging Face `BAAI/bge-base-en-v1.5` via `sentence-transformers`
Vector database	Pinecone (serverless)
PDF parsing	`pypdf` / LangChain `PyPDFLoader`
Containerization	Docker
CI/CD	GitHub Actions → Amazon ECR → Amazon EC2 (self-hosted runner)

📁 Project Structure

```
Medical-Chatbot-/
├── .github/workflows/cicd.yaml   # CI/CD pipeline (build → ECR → EC2)
├── assets/
│   └── medibot-flow.png          # Request-flow diagram used in this README
├── data/
│   └── Medical_book.pdf          # Knowledge-base source document
├── research/
│   └── trials.ipynb              # Experiments / prototyping notebook
├── src/
│   ├── __init__.py
│   ├── helper.py                 # PDF loading, filtering, chunking, embeddings
│   ├── prompt.py                 # System prompt for the assistant
│   └── store_index.py            # Builds and populates the Pinecone index
├── templates/
│   └── index.html                # Chat front end
├── app.py                        # Flask app + RAG chain
├── dockerfile                    # Container image definition
├── requirements.txt              # Python dependencies
├── setup.py                      # Package metadata
├── template.sh                   # Script that scaffolds the project layout
└── LICENSE                       # Apache 2.0
```

🚀 Getting Started

Prerequisites

- Python **3.10+** (3.12 recommended)
- A Pinecone account and API key
- An OpenAI API key
- (Optional) Conda, Docker, and an AWS account for deployment

1. Clone the repository

```
git clone https://github.com/dhanushkapg/Medical-Chatbot-.git
cd Medical-Chatbot-
```

2. Create and activate an environment

```
conda create -n medicalbot python=3.12 -y
conda activate medicalbot
```

3. Install the dependencies

```
pip install -r requirements.txt
```

4. Configure the environment variables

Create a `.env` file in the project root:

```
PINECONE_API_KEY="your-pinecone-api-key"
OPENAI_API_KEY="your-openai-api-key"
```

📚 Building the Vector Index

Run the ingestion script once, or again whenever you add PDFs to `data/`:

```
python src/store_index.py
```

The script will:

1. Create the Pinecone index if it does not exist yet (dimension `768`, metric `cosine`, serverless on AWS `us-east-1`).
2. Load and chunk every PDF in `data/`.
3. Embed the chunks and store them in Pinecone.

> **Note:** `src/store_index.py` creates an index named `medicalbottest`, but `app.py` reads from an index named `medicalbot`. Make the two names match before you run the app.
>
> `src/helper.py` also changes the working directory to a hard-coded local path (`os.chdir(...)`). Update or remove that line to match your machine.

💬 Running the App

```
python app.py
```

Open **http://127.0.0.1:5000** in your browser and start asking questions, for example:

- *What is HIV?*
- *Explain blood pressure*
- *What is type 2 diabetes?*

🔌 API Reference

`GET /`

Serves the chat interface (`templates/index.html`).

`POST /chat`

Sends a question to the RAG chain and returns the generated answer.

Request

```
{ "question": "What are the symptoms of anemia?" }
```

Responses

Status	Body	When
`200`	`{ "answer": "..." }`	Success
`400`	`{ "error": "Please enter a question." }`	Empty or missing `question`
`500`	`{ "error": "Sorry, I couldn't generate an answer. Please try again." }`	Retrieval or LLM failure

Example

```
curl -X POST http://127.0.0.1:5000/chat \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{"question": "What is hypertension?"}'
```

🐳 Docker

Build and run the container locally:

```
docker build -t medical-chatbot .
docker run -d \
  -e PINECONE_API_KEY="your-pinecone-api-key" \
  -e OPENAI_API_KEY="your-openai-api-key" \
  -p 8080:8080 \
  medical-chatbot
```

> **Note:** The container maps port `8080`, but `app.run(debug=True)` listens on `127.0.0.1:5000` by default. For the app to be reachable from outside the container, start it with `app.run(host="0.0.0.0", port=8080)`.

☁️ CI/CD Deployment to AWS

The workflow in .github/workflows/cicd.yaml runs on every push to `main`:

1. **Continuous Integration** (`ubuntu-latest`) - Checks out the code - Configures AWS credentials and logs in to Amazon ECR - Builds the Docker image and pushes it to ECR with the `latest` tag
2. **Continuous Deployment** (a `self-hosted` runner on EC2) - Logs in to ECR - Pulls the image and runs it on port `8080`, passing in the API keys as environment variables

AWS setup

1. Create an **IAM user** with the `AmazonEC2ContainerRegistryFullAccess` and `AmazonEC2FullAccess` policies.
2. Create an **ECR repository** for the image.
3. Launch an **EC2 instance** (Ubuntu) and install Docker: `bash sudo apt-get update -y && sudo apt-get upgrade -y curl -fsSL https://get.docker.com -o get-docker.sh sudo sh get-docker.sh sudo usermod -aG docker ubuntu newgrp docker`
4. Register the EC2 instance as a **self-hosted GitHub Actions runner** (*Settings → Actions → Runners → New self-hosted runner*).
5. Open port **8080** in the instance's security group.

Required GitHub secrets

Secret	Description
`AWS_ACCESS_KEY_ID`	IAM user access key
`AWS_SECRET_ACCESS_KEY`	IAM user secret key
`AWS_DEFAULT_REGION`	AWS region, e.g. `us-east-1`
`ECR_REPO`	Name of the ECR repository
`PINECONE_API_KEY`	Pinecone API key
`OPENAI_API_KEY`	OpenAI API key

⚙️ Configuration

The main settings and where to find them:

Setting	Value	File
Pinecone index name	`medicalbot`	app.py
Retriever top-k	`4`	app.py
LLM model	`gpt-4.1-mini`	app.py
LLM temperature	`0.6`	app.py
Embedding model	`BAAI/bge-base-en-v1.5`	src/helper.py
Chunk size / overlap	`500` / `20`	src/helper.py
System prompt	Medical assistant rules	src/prompt.py

License

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